



Bellarine and Geelong Wine Region

While Yarra Valley is the more popular wine region in Southern Australia, the Bellarine and Geelong region punches way above its weight, producing a series of award-winning wines such as Chardonnay and Shiraz. It takes just over an hour from Mel-

bourne to reach the wine country. Stop at any of the 40-odd winemakers and enjoy a tasting. Many also have cafes and restaurants where you can unwind over great food and of course, wine! Walk through the vineyards, go on a tour of the cellar or simply indulge in some great wine. Insider tip: The wine tasting itself is quite reasonably priced at around AUD\$20 for 12-14 wines, but if you don't have a sober driver with you, you are better off booking a wine tour from Melbourne which can cost up to AUD\$200 per person. While in the region, also taste craft beer and gin.



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The Q Train

Dining on The Q Train—Australia's premier rail restaurant—is quite an experience. The train travels along the historic and scenic Bellarine Railway—between Drysdale and Queenscliff. Drive down one and half hours to Drysdale from Melbourne and board The Q Train. Over the next three hours, enjoy a five-course meal on board, where each dish showcases local produce and ingredients accompanied with Australian (specifically Victorian) wine, beer, and cocktails (drinks have to be paid for separately). All meals are freshly cooked in the train's kitchen and there is also a vegetarian option, provided you book it in advance. The train stops briefly at Queenscliff, where you can get down to stretch your legs before it makes its way back to Drysdale. The experience including the meal costs AUD\$139 per person.